SS-P-166d
AMENDMENT-6
September 22, 1972
SUPERSEDING
Amendment-5
April 5, 1972

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PENCILS, LEAD

This amendment, which forms a part of Federal Specification SS-P-166d, dated March 10, 1961, was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

PAGE 1

Paragraph 2.1: Under Federal Specifications delete PPP-T-97 - Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced and add:

QQ-S-781 - Strapping, Steel, Flat and Seals.
PPP-P-1660 - Pallet, Expendable.
PPP-S-760 - Strapping, Nonmetallic (and Connectors).

Under Federal Standards delete Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

PAGE 2

Add paragraph 2.2 as follows:

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard:

D 2088 - Determination of Low Concentration of Lead

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Table I, under "Dimensions or diameters of leads (inch)".

For type II checking pencils, delete minimum and maximum diameters specified and substitute "0.140" and "0.165", respectively.

For type V, extra-thin lead, delete minimum and maximum diameters specified for each of the three degrees of hardness of lead and substitute "0.058", minimum and "0.073", maximum for each.

FSC 7510

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:12Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

PAGE 2 (con.)

Paragraph 3.5.1: Delete and substitute:

3.5.1 Carpenter pencils shall have lead as indicated in table I. The casing shall be finished with bright colored lacquer. The lead content (calculated as the metal) of the finish shall not exceed 0.5 percent of the total weight of the contained solids or dried paint film when tested in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard D 2088. The length of the finished pencil shall be not less than 6-3/4 inches.

PAGE 3

Paragraph 3.5.2, 3.5.3, 3.5.4, and 3.5.6: Delete and substitute:

3.5.2 Checking pencils shall have black graphite lead (see 3.1.1), as indicated in table I. The pencils shall be untipped, round or hexagonal, and shall be finished with a good polish; natural or in colors. The lead content (calculated as the metal) of the finish shall not exceed 0.5 percent of the total weight of the contained solids or dried paint film when tested in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard D 2088.

3.5.3 Copying pencils shall have lead as indicated in table I and shall be provided with medium or hard lead as specified (see 1.2.1 and 6.2). The lead shall be indelible and made from a graphite and dye composition. The pencil shall write black and copy purple. Casing shall be round and finished with a good polish; natural or in colors. The lead content of the finish shall not exceed 0.5 percent of the total weight of the contained solids or dried paint film when tested in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard D 2088.

3.5.4 General writing pencils shall be not less than 6-11/16 inches long, not including tip and eraser. Each pencil shall be provided with a suitable metal tip which firmly secures a rubber eraser. The eraser shall be in accordance with Federal Specification ZZ-E-661, type I, grade B. Pencils shall be rounded or hexagonal and shall be finished with a colored lacquer. The lead content (calculated as the metal) of the finish shall not exceed 0.5 percent of the total weight of the contained solids or dried paint film when tested in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard D 2088.

3.5.6 Stenographer pencils shall be untipped at both ends. The casing shall be round, 1/4 inch ± 1/32 inch in diameter and finished with a good polish, natural or in colors. The lead content (calculated as the metal) of the finish shall not exceed 0.5 percent of the total weight of the contained solids or dried paint when tested in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard D 2088.

PAGE 4

Section 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY: Delete in its entirety and substitute:

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit packaging. Twelve pencils of one type, class and degree of hardness, as applicable shall be packaged in a paperboard open end sleeve, clear plastic covered tray, or other suitable container in accordance with the manufacturer's standard commercial practice.

5.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Six unit packages of pencils of one type, class and degree of hardness, as applicable, shall be packaged in a paperboard box of the type normally used by the manufacturer.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Pencils, in the quantity specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), of one type, class and degree of hardness as applicable, shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c or V3s, style RSC. Each box shall be fitted with a case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. The liner shall be sealed. Closing, sealing and strapping of the fiberboard box shall be in accordance with the requirements in the appendix to PPP-B-636.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:12Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

PAGE 4 (con.)

5.2.2 Level B. Unless specified otherwise (see 6.2), twenty intermediate packages (120 dozen pencils) of one type, class and degree of hardness, as applicable shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, style RSC.

5.2.3 Level C. Pencils of one type, class and degree of hardness, as applicable, shall be packed in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice. The shipping containers shall comply with the Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Palletization. At the option of the supplier, shipments may be palletized. The pallet shall conform to PPP-P-1660, Type I or II, Style optional, class B or C, Grade 1, Size optional. Items of different stock numbers may be placed on a pallet provided the pallet load is marked on all four sides, in letters not less than one-half inch high with the following: MIXED CONTENTS. The load shall be secure to the pallet with steel or nonmetallic strapping conforming to QQ-S-781 or PPP-S-760.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order (see 6.2), marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order (see 6.2), marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

PAGE 6

Paragraph 6.2, 6.4, and 6.5: Delete text in their entirety and substitute:

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type of pencil desired (see 1.2.1).
(c) Class when type III pencils are required (see 1.2.1).
(d) Degree of lead hardness when type III, IV, or V pencils are required (see 1.2.1).
(e) Data, as required, regarding examination and tests; and inspection responsibility (for Civil agencies only) if other than as specified herein (see 4.1).
(f) Level of packing required (see 5.2).
(g) Quantity of the shipping container (see 5.2.1).
(h) When a different quantity is required in the shipping container (see 5.2.2).
(i) Special markings required (see 5.4.1 and 5.4.2).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:12Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.